

Jake Chitel

Senior Software Engineer

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Senior Full-Stack Engineer with a proven track record of designing, building, and scaling complex web and mobile architectures across frontend (React/TypeScript), backend (NodeJS/.NET), and iOS (Swift/SwiftUI) ecosystems. Adept at guiding critical legacy migrations, establishing engineering standards, and unblocking cross-functional teams as a senior technical owner. Expert at combining deep software design principles with modern development workflows, actively leveraging AI-native coding assistants, including GitHub Copilot, Claude Code, and Cursor, to accelerate feature velocity, optimize code refactoring, and reduce time-to-production in fast-paced, adaptive environments.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

TypeScript
NodeJS
HTML/CSS
Claude Code
C#/.NET
Python
Rust
AWS

JavaScript
Next.js
Vite
Cursor
PowerShell
Django
bash
Terraform

React
TailwindCSS
GitHub Copilot
SQL
Swift/SwiftUI
Java
Git
REST

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Northwestern Mutual

Software Engineer III

Apr 2025 - Apr 2026

- Transformed monolithic Scala compute engine into modular, graph-based architecture, enhancing scalability and maintainability for real-time financial planning workflows, leveraging AI tools like GitHub Copilot.
- Accelerated modernization efforts by 25% using GitHub Copilot, enhancing efficiency and gaining expertise in AI-assisted development practices.

Direct Supply

Staff Software Engineer

Jun 2022 – Feb 2025

- Drove multi-team initiative to design, align, and implement centralized frontend development standards.
- Mentored junior software engineers, providing technical guidance, code reviews, and architectural advice based on industry experience.
- Served as principal frontend subject matter expert (SME) to unblock and guide multiple cross-functional engineering teams.
- Designed strategic migration plan to decompose and restructure complex legacy system to React, leveraging AI-assisted coding to accelerate modernization and directly improve code maintainability.
- Refactored concurrent code structures within iOS application, successfully reducing crash rates by >50%.
- Improved quote submission by developing ML-powered workflows, significantly boosting processing efficiency and reducing manual operational work.

Arch Capital Group

Software Engineer IV

Jun 2021 - Jun 2022

- Applied frontend engineering expertise to optimize and scale large, data-dense React codebase.

- Formulated comprehensive migration plan to refactor legacy class components into functional components utilizing React hooks.
- Designed and developed new user experience (UX) to streamline rendering of complex pricing data and insurance policy computations.

Direct Supply

Senior Software Engineer

Sep 2017 - Jun 2021

- Spearheaded project to rebuild core mobile application from scratch, rapidly mastering and integrating new technical frameworks to ensure platform longevity.
- Architected and implemented cross-functional automations to eliminate critical operational bottlenecks, accelerating build pipelines and infrastructure engineering velocity.
- Integrated and maintained modular React applications directly into legacy Angular codebases.

GE Healthcare

Software Engineer

May 2017 - Sep 2017

- Architected and developed a PHP-based platform engine designed to parse comprehensive data logs, isolate critical failure points, and extract historical event data.

D+H

Software Engineer

Jul 2016 - May 2017

- Maintained and optimized highly configurable, complex N-tier SaaS application, engineering reusable core business logic and dynamic frontend UI components tailored for mortgage application workflows.
- Designed, developed, and deployed secure, production-grade integration layer connecting with an official government identity verification service.

Amazon Web Services

Software Development Engineer

Jun 2015 - Jun 2016

- Orchestrated the architectural migration of the AWS Lambda console from Angular to React, engineering a modern build system utilizing Webpack and Babel to optimize bundle sizes and performance.
- Developed and validated cloud console user interface features by consuming and thoroughly testing the public-facing AWS API.
- Architected and deployed the frontend user interface for the core initial release integrating AWS Lambda with API Gateway.
- Designed backend API endpoints and implemented intuitive frontend interfaces to manage complex workflows for function versioning and aliases.

Marquette University GasDay Lab

Software Developer

Aug 2011 - May 2015

- Maintained system for ingesting, processing, storing, and displaying weather and natural gas data using tech including NodeJS, TypeScript, React, Next.js, TailwindCSS, .NET, Azure, SQL, JavaScript, and jQuery.
- Designed dashboard page to display graphs of forecasted vs. actual weather and natural gas data.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Marquette University | Milwaukee, WI

Bachelor of Science, Computer Engineering